GA4 Report Analysis – Google Merchandise Store Demo

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Overview

This report analyses the official GA4 demo property for the Google Merchandise Store to identify key acquisition, engagement and conversion metrics. Task: Digital Marketing Track – Explore Google Analytics 4 Reports. Author: Sadhanala Nischay Prasad.

Item	Detail
Property	GA4 – Google Merchandise Store (web data stream)
Access	Google Analytics demo account (free, view-only, linked from Google Analytics Help → "Demo account")
Date range used	[fill, e.g. Last 28 days: 28 Sep – 25 Oct 2026]
Reports explored	Reports snapshot, Traffic acquisition, User acquisition, Engagement overview, Pages and screens, Events, Key events, Ecommerce purchases, Purchase journey, Tech and Demographic details

Method: every number in this report was read directly from the GA4 interface for the date range above, and each section links to its screenshot in the `screenshots/` folder of the GitHub repo.

Key metric definitions

GA4 is event-based: every interaction (page_view, scroll, add_to_cart, purchase) is an event, and users, sessions and engagement are built from those events.

Metric	What it means
Total users / Active users	Distinct people who visited; active users had at least one engaged session
New users	People visiting for the first time in the date range
Sessions	A group of interactions; a session ends after 30 minutes of inactivity
Engaged session	Lasted 10+ seconds, had a key event, or had 2+ page/screen views
Engagement rate	Engaged sessions ÷ sessions (the opposite of bounce rate)
Average engagement time	Time the site was in focus in the browser, per active user
Key event	An event marked as important (renamed from "conversion" in 2024), e.g. purchase
Session key event rate	Share of sessions that triggered a key event
Session default channel group	Where a session came from: Direct, Organic Search, Paid Search, Referral, Email, etc.

Traffic-source analysis

[Fill: one-sentence finding, e.g. "Direct and Organic Search bring X% of all sessions, while Paid Search has the highest engagement rate at Y%."]

Where to find it: Reports → Acquisition → Traffic acquisition (dimension: Session default channel group). Screenshot: `screenshots/03-traffic-acquisition.png`.

Channel	Sessions	Engaged sessions	Engagement rate	Key events	Revenue
Direct					
Organic Search					
Paid Search					
Referral					
Unassigned					

Channel	Sessions	Engaged sessions	Engagement rate	Key events	Revenue
Email / Organic Social / other					

Observations (write 3–4 from your table):

- Largest channel by sessions and its share of the total:
- Channel with the best engagement rate:
- Channel that drives the most key events or revenue per session:
- Share of "Unassigned" traffic, and why it matters (missing or broken UTM tagging hides the true source).

Also check User acquisition (First user default channel group) to see which channel brings new people versus returning ones.

Engagement analysis

[Fill: one-sentence finding, e.g. "Users stay about Xm Ys on average, and the home page and apparel pages hold most of the views."]

Where to find it: Reports → Engagement → Overview, Pages and screens, and Events. Screenshots: `04-engagement-overview.png`, `05-pages-and-screens.png`, `06-events.png`.

Metric	Value
Average engagement time per active user	
Engaged sessions per active user	
Engagement rate (from Traffic acquisition)	
Views per active user	

Top page (title)	Views	Active users	Avg. engagement time
1.			
2.			
3.			

Top page (title)	Views	Active users	Avg. engagement time
4.			
5.			

Top events by count (Events report): page_view, user_engagement, session_start, scroll, view_item … [list your top 5 with counts].

Observations:

- Which pages keep users longest, and which get views but little engagement time:
- Device split (Tech → Tech details, dimension Device category): desktop vs mobile share and engagement rate:
- Top countries (Demographic details) and whether engagement differs by country:

Conversion observations

[Fill: one-sentence finding, e.g. "Only X% of sessions end in a purchase; the biggest drop is between add-to-cart and checkout."]

Where to find it: Reports → Engagement → Key events; Monetization → Ecommerce purchases and Purchase journey. Screenshots: `07-key-events.png`, `08-ecommerce-purchases.png`, `09-purchase-journey.png`.

Key metric	Value
Total key events	
Session key event rate	
Purchases (transactions)	
Total revenue	
Average purchase revenue	

Purchase journey (from the Purchase journey report):

Step	Active users	Drop-off from previous step
Session start		–

Step	Active users	Drop-off from previous step
View product		
Add to cart		
Begin checkout		
Purchase		

Observations:

- Step with the largest drop-off, and a likely reason (price, shipping cost, forced sign-in):
- Top-selling items by revenue versus by quantity (Ecommerce purchases):
- Channel with the highest key event rate (from the Traffic acquisition table):

Five marketing insights

Each insight follows the pattern data → meaning → action. The patterns below are the ones this demo property commonly shows; replace every [X] with your own numbers and drop any insight your data does not support.

1. **Organic and direct traffic carry the store.** Direct and Organic Search bring [X]% of sessions. Action: invest in SEO for product and category pages, since this traffic is free and already strong.
2. **Untracked traffic hides real sources.** "Unassigned" or "(not set)" accounts for [X]% of sessions. Action: add UTM parameters to every email, social and partner link so each channel's performance is measurable.
3. **The cart is where buyers are lost.** [X]% of users who add to cart never begin checkout, and only [X]% of sessions purchase. Action: run cart-abandonment emails, show shipping costs earlier and allow guest checkout.
4. **Mobile under-converts compared with desktop.** Mobile is [X]% of users but its key event rate is [X]% versus [X]% on desktop. Action: simplify the mobile checkout and test page speed on phones.
5. **A few pages and products drive most value.** The top 5 pages take [X]% of views, and [product] leads revenue. Action: feature best sellers on the home page and in ads, and retarget visitors who viewed them without buying.

Screenshots and conclusion

File	GA4 report
01-home-property.png	Home page showing the Google Merchandise Store property
02-reports-snapshot.png	Reports → Reports snapshot
03-traffic-acquisition.png	Acquisition → Traffic acquisition
04-engagement-overview.png	Engagement → Overview
05-pages-and-screens.png	Engagement → Pages and screens
06-events.png	Engagement → Events
07-key-events.png	Engagement → Key events
08-ecommerce-purchases.png	Monetization → Ecommerce purchases
09-purchase-journey.png	Monetization → Purchase journey
10-tech-details.png	Tech → Tech details (Device category)

Conclusion: this exercise covered how GA4 measures users, sessions, engagement and key events, and how to turn report numbers into marketing actions. [Fill: one sentence on your biggest takeaway.]